INDIAN MORAL THINKERS AND PHILOSOPHERS

REALIST-IDEALIST SPECTRUM IN INDIAN → KAUTILYA'S ANTI-CORRUPTION CONTROL ARCHITECTURE → BUDDHA'S MIDDLE PATH AS → GANDHI'S ETHICAL TOOLKIT: TRUSTEESHIP → VIVEKANANDA'S PRACTICAL VEDANTA AND → BASAVA'S KAYAKA, DASOHA AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 REALIST-IDEALIST SPECTRUM IN INDIAN MORAL THOUGHT

STAGE 00 · REALIST-IDEALIST SPECTRUM IN INDIAN MORAL THOUGHT · CENTRAL FOCUS · 1. REALIST-IDEALIST SPECTRUM IN INDIAN MORAL THOUGHT · (1) KAUTILYA ANCHORS THE REALIST POLE · ASSUME TEMPTATION IS STRUCTURAL. · (2) REALIST DESIGN · ROTATION, DUAL CUSTODY, AUDIT, POSITIVE INCENTIVE · (3) GANDHI ANCHORS THE IDEALIST POLE

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Realist-idealist spectrum in Indian moral thought
- [1] Kautilya anchors the realist pole: assume temptation is structural.
- [2] Realist design: rotation, dual custody, audit, positive incentive.
- [3] Gandhi anchors the idealist pole: moral transformation through example.

MECHANISM
- [4] Idealist design: trusteeship, self-purification, exemplar-based reform.
- [5] Vivekananda, Basava, Nanak share the idealist register with distinct mechanisms.
- [6] Buddha's Middle Path sits at the synthesising centre.
- [7] Modern governance is Kautilyan in institutional design, Gandhian in aspiration.
- [8] Neither pole alone is sufficient; synthesis is the examiner's expected conclusion.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDICT — Name both registers and the synthesis point in every Indian-thinkers answer.
- ANSWER USE — Use as the opening framework for any realist-vs-idealist thinker question.
- MUST REMEMBER: Indian ethical thought must retain each thinker's own problem, concepts,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Name both registers and the synthesis point in every Indian-thinkers answer.

01 KAUTILYA'S ANTI-CORRUPTION CONTROL ARCHITECTURE

STAGE 01 · KAUTILYA'S ANTI-CORRUPTION CONTROL ARCHITECTURE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 2. KAUTILYA'S ANTI-CORRUPTION CONTROL ARCHITECTURE · (1) PREMISE · OFFICIALS HANDLING PUBLIC MONEY FACE STRUCTURAL TEMPTATION. · (2) ARC ANNEXURE-I(2) QUOTES KANGLE 2.9.32 · HONEY-AND-POISON PASSAGE. · (3) FISH ANALOGY (2.9.33)

CENTRAL FOCUS → 2. Kautilya's anti-corruption control architecture → [1] Premise: officials handling public money face structural temptation. → [2] ARC Annexure-I(2) quotes Kangle 2.9.32: honey-and-poison passage. → [3] Fish analogy (2.9.33): embezzlement is as unobservable as a fish drinking water.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. Kautilya's anti-corruption control architecture
- [1] Premise: officials handling public money face structural temptation.
- [2] ARC Annexure-I(2) quotes Kangle 2.9.32: honey-and-poison passage.

MECHANISM
- [3] Fish analogy (2.9.33): embezzlement is as unobservable as a fish drinking water.
- [4] Bird analogy (2.9.34): concealed intentions are harder to detect than bird paths.
- [5] Response: rotation, audit, inspection, reassignment of suspect officials.
- [6] Positive incentive: those who increase wealth justly are made permanent.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Modern analogues: risk-based CBDT audit; dual custody, Lokpal.
- [8] Limit: pure surveillance without service-motivation demoralises honest officers.
- VERDICT — Kautilya provides the structural premise; pair it with idealist motivation for balance.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build the anti-corruption-design paragraph in any Kautilya question.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Kautilya provides the structural premise; pair it with idealist motivation for balance.

02 BUDDHA'S MIDDLE PATH AS A DECISION-PROCEDURE

STAGE 02 · BUDDHA'S MIDDLE PATH AS A DECISION-PROCEDURE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 3. BUDDHA'S MIDDLE PATH AS A DECISION-PROCEDURE · (1) OVER-REACTION POLE · EXCESSIVE, PUNITIVE, POPULIST CRACKDOWN. · (2) UNDER-REACTION POLE · COMPLACENT INACTION DRIVEN BY RISK-AVERSION. · (3) MIDDLE PATH TESTS

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Buddha's Middle Path as a decision-procedure → [1] Over-reaction pole: excessive, punitive, populist crackdown. → [2] Under-reaction pole: complacent inaction driven by risk-aversion.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Buddha's Middle Path as a decision-procedure
- [1] Over-reaction pole: excessive, punitive, populist crackdown.
- [2] Under-reaction pole: complacent inaction driven by risk-aversion.

MECHANISM
- [3] Middle Path tests: is this response proportionate to the actual risk?
- [4] Eightfold Path: Right Action (lawful conduct) maps to official duty.
- [5] Eightfold Path: Right Livelihood (honest occupation) maps to career ethics.
- [6] Eightfold Path: Right Mindfulness (self-aware judgement) maps to bias-checking.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Proportionality discipline prevents both populist demolitions and wilful neglect.
- [8] Limit: Middle Path provides the test but not the substantive legal standard.
- VERDICT — The Middle Path converts 'be balanced' from vague advice into a testable procedure.
- ANSWER USE — Use as the proportionality check in any case-study or vigilance question.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — The Middle Path converts 'be balanced' from vague advice into a testable procedure.

03 GANDHI'S ETHICAL TOOLKIT: TRUSTEESHIP, MEANS-ENDS, SEVEN SOCIAL SINS

STAGE 03 · GANDHI'S ETHICAL TOOLKIT · TRUSTEESHIP, MEANS-ENDS, SEVEN SOCIAL SINS · CENTRAL FOCUS · 4. GANDHI'S ETHICAL TOOLKIT · (1) TRUSTEESHIP · POWER AND WEALTH HELD FOR SOCIETY, NOT AS PERSONAL · (2) ENDS-MEANS UNITY · IMPURE MEANS CORRUPT EVEN A GOOD END (STRICT DEONTOLOGICAL-VIRTUE

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Gandhi's ethical toolkit: trusteeship, means-ends, Seven Social Sins
- [1] Trusteeship: power and wealth held for society, not as personal property.
- [2] Ends-means unity: impure means corrupt even a good end (strict deontological-virtue hybrid).

MECHANISM
- [3] Seven Social Sins (ARC Box 2.8): seven decouplings that destroy ethical governance.
- [4] ARC wording has 'leisure without conscience'; Young India 1925 has 'pleasure without conscience'.
- [5] Gandhi received the list from a correspondent; he published it without claiming authorship.
- [6] Satyagraha: non-violent resistance grounded in truth-force.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Administrative translation: bureaucrat holds authority in trust for citizens.
- [8] Limit: idealism alone under-designs institutional safeguards.
- VERDICT — Gandhi provides the aspirational register; always pair with institutional mechanism.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any Gandhi quotation, trusteeship or means-ends answer.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — ANSWER USE — Use to build any Gandhi quotation, trusteeship or means-ends answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Gandhi provides the aspirational register; always pair with institutional mechanism.

04 VIVEKANANDA'S PRACTICAL VEDANTA AND DARIDRA NARAYANA

STAGE 04 · VIVEKANANDA'S PRACTICAL VEDANTA AND DARIDRA NARAYANA · CENTRAL FOCUS · 5. VIVEKANANDA'S PRACTICAL VEDANTA AND DARIDRA NARAYANA · (1) ADVAITA NON-DUALISM · THE SELF IN ALL BEINGS IS ONE. · (2) LOGICAL CONSEQUENCE · SERVING THE DEPRIVED IS SERVING THE DIVINE. · (3) DARIDRA NARAYANA

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Vivekananda's Practical Vedanta and Daridra Narayana
- [1] Advaita non-dualism: the self in all beings is one.
- [2] Logical consequence: serving the deprived is serving the divine.

MECHANISM
- [3] Daridra Narayana: God in the poor, collapsing sacred-secular distinction.
- [4] Selective learning: absorb what is good from others in your own way (2024 Q2a).
- [5] 2025 Q3(c): 'morality of a people' line attributed by UPSC, not in Complete Works.
- [6] Welfare administration elevated from obligation to devotional duty.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Rejects charity model in favour of dignity model of service.
- [8] Limit: devotional motivation needs institutional accountability to prevent paternalism.
- VERDICT — Cite Practical Vedanta's logic chain, not just the inspirational conclusion.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any Vivekananda quotation or service-ethics answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Cite Practical Vedanta's logic chain, not just the inspirational conclusion.

05 BASAVA'S KAYAKA, DASOHA AND THE ANUBHAVA MANTAPA

STAGE 05 · BASAVA'S KAYAKA, DASOHA AND THE ANUBHAVA MANTAPA · CENTRAL FOCUS · 6. BASAVA'S KAYAKA, DASOHA AND THE ANUBHAVA MANTAPA · (1) KAYAKAVE KAILASA · DIGNIFIED HONEST WORK IS ITSELF THE DIVINE ABODE · (2) DASOHA · SHARING SURPLUS IN COMMUNITY SERVICE, NOT PERSONAL ACCUMULATION. · (3) ANUBHAVA MANTAPA

CENTRAL FOCUS → 6. Basava's Kayaka, Dasoha and the Anubhava Mantapa → [1] Kayakave Kailasa: dignified honest work is itself the divine abode. → [2] Dasoha: sharing surplus in community service, not personal accumulation. → [3] Anubhava Mantapa: tradition-attested assembly of sharanas across caste and gender.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Basava's Kayaka, Dasoha and the Anubhava Mantapa
- [1] Kayakave Kailasa: dignified honest work is itself the divine abode.
- [2] Dasoha: sharing surplus in community service, not personal accumulation.

MECHANISM
- [3] Anubhava Mantapa: tradition-attested assembly of sharanas across caste and gender.
- [4] NOT 'world's first parliament': tradition-attested, not securely dated.
- [5] Anticipates Article 17 (abolition of untouchability) and Article 23 (forced labour).
- [6] Proto-egalitarian labour ethic: all honest labour carries equal worth.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] 12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijala.
- [8] Limit: medieval concepts need disciplined analogy, not identity claims.
- VERDICT — Present Basava as a historical antecedent to constitutional equality, not its source.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any Basava, dignity-of-labour or anti-discrimination answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Present Basava as a historical antecedent to constitutional equality, not its source.

06 GURU NANAK'S THREE PILLARS AND PUBLIC-RESOURCE ETHICS

STAGE 06 · GURU NANAK'S THREE PILLARS AND PUBLIC-RESOURCE ETHICS · CENTRAL FOCUS · 7. GURU NANAK'S THREE PILLARS AND PUBLIC-RESOURCE ETHICS · (1) NAAM JAPNA · REMEMBRANCE OF THE DIVINE NAME, GROUNDING ETHICAL CONDUCT SPIRITUALLY. · (2) KIRAT KARO · EARN THROUGH HONEST LABOUR, OPPOSING RENT-SEEKING AND CORRUPTION. · (3) VAND CHHAKO

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Guru Nanak's three pillars and public-resource ethics → [1] Naam Japna: remembrance of the divine name, grounding ethical conduct spiritually. → [2] Kirat Karo: earn through honest labour, opposing rent-seeking and corruption.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Guru Nanak's three pillars and public-resource ethics
- [1] Naam Japna: remembrance of the divine name, grounding ethical conduct spiritually.
- [2] Kirat Karo: earn through honest labour, opposing rent-seeking and corruption.

MECHANISM
- [3] Vand Chhako: share with others, supporting equity-oriented resource allocation.
- [4] Public-finance analogy: honest revenue collection + equitable expenditure.
- [5] Scriptural basis firm: Guru Granth Sahib, Angs 8 and 1245.
- [6] 'Three pillars' phrasing is later pedagogical packaging, not Guru Nanak's verbatim triad.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Classical antecedent of bridging social capital through inter-community sharing.
- [8] Limit: normative ideal, not a self-enforcing mechanism; needs institutional accountability.
- VERDICT — Use the content accurately but flag the pedagogical packaging of the 'three pillars' label.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any Guru Nanak or public-resource ethics answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Use the content accurately but flag the pedagogical packaging of the 'three pillars' label.

07 MAHAVIR'S FIVE MAHAVRATAS AND ANEKANTAVADA

STAGE 07 · MAHAVIR'S FIVE MAHAVRATAS AND ANEKANTAVADA · CENTRAL FOCUS · 8. MAHAVIR'S FIVE MAHAVRATAS AND ANEKANTAVADA · (1) FIVE MAHAVRATAS · AHIMSA, SATYA, ASTEYA, BRAHMACHARYA, APARIGRAHA. · (2) PARSHVANATHA HAD FOUR VOWS; MAHAVIR SEPARATELY ENUMERATED BRAHMACHARYA · (3) ANEKANTAVADA · MANY-SIDEDNESS OF TRUTH, NO SINGLE PERSPECTIVE CAPTURES THE WHOLE.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Mahavir's five Mahavratas and Anekantavada
- [1] Five Mahavratas: Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha.
- [2] Parshvanatha had four vows; Mahavir separately enumerated Brahmacharya as the fifth.

MECHANISM
- [3] Anekantavada: many-sidedness of truth, no single perspective captures the whole.
- [4] Syadvada: conditional predication, the logical expression of Anekantavada.
- [5] Administrative use: multi-stakeholder consultation before policy decisions.
- [6] Aparigraha: non-possessiveness, cautions against accumulation and nepotism.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Trap: Anekantavada is NOT 'no view is ever correct' but 'truth is many-sided'.
- [8] Limit: Anekantavada taken too far risks indecision; a cut-off for deliberation is needed.
- VERDICT — Present Anekantavada as a consultative process principle, not as relativism.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any Mahavir, Jain ethics or multi-stakeholder answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Present Anekantavada as a consultative process principle, not as relativism.

08 AMBEDKAR'S CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY, EQUALITY AND FRATERNITY

STAGE 08 · AMBEDKAR'S CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY, EQUALITY AND FRATERNITY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 9. AMBEDKAR'S CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY, EQUALITY AND FRATERNITY · (1) CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY (4 NOV 1948) · PARAMOUNT REVERENCE FOR CONSTITUTIONAL FORMS (GROTE). · (2) INCLUDES THE RIGHT OF OPEN SPEECH AND UNRESTRAINED · (3) EQUALITY WARNING (25 NOV 1949) · LIFE OF CONTRADICTIONS IF SOCIAL INEQUALITY PERSISTS.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Ambedkar's constitutional morality, equality and fraternity
- [1] Constitutional morality (4 Nov 1948): paramount reverence for constitutional forms (Grote).
- [2] Includes the right of open speech and unrestrained censure of authorities.

MECHANISM
- [3] Equality warning (25 Nov 1949): life of contradictions if social inequality persists.
- [4] Political equality without social equality risks democratic collapse.
- [5] Fraternity: common brotherhood that makes liberty and equality self-sustaining.
- [6] Without fraternity, constitutional values need a policeman to enforce them.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Institutional safeguards: judicial review, fundamental rights, minority protections.
- [8] Trap: Ambedkar is NOT only a Polity figure; his ethics content is independently examinable.
- VERDICT — Use the morality-equality-fraternity triad to show Ambedkar's GS-IV relevance.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any constitutional-morality, equality or affirmative-action answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Use the morality-equality-fraternity triad to show Ambedkar's GS-IV relevance.

09 SOCIAL CAPITAL: BONDING VERSUS BRIDGING

STAGE 09 · SOCIAL CAPITAL · BONDING VERSUS BRIDGING · CENTRAL FOCUS · 10. SOCIAL CAPITAL · (1) SOCIAL CAPITAL · NETWORKS OF TRUST ENABLING COLLECTIVE ACTION (PUTNAM). · (2) BONDING CAPITAL · WITHIN A CLOSE-KNIT GROUP, STRENGTHENS IN-GROUP COHESION.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[4] Bonding-only risk: nepotism, gatekeeping, exclusion of outsiders.	VERDICT — Social capital earns marks only when the bonding-bridging distinction is drawn.
10. Social capital: bonding versus bridging	[5] MKSS social audits in Rajasthan: work because bridging capital exists or is built.	ANSWER USE — Use to build any social-capital, participatory-governance or social-audit answer.
[1] Social capital: networks of trust enabling collective action (Putnam).	[6] Jan sunwai (public hearing): requires villagers to trust the process and each other.	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Dharma is contextually ordered duty and right conduct, not a simple...
[2] Bonding capital: within a close-knit group, strengthens in-group cohesion.	[7] Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako and Basava's Dasoha are classical bridging antecedents.	

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Social capital: bonding versus bridging
- [1] Social capital: networks of trust enabling collective action (Putnam)
- [2] Bonding capital: within a close-knit group, strengthens in-group cohesion.
- [3] Bridging capital: across groups, enables inclusive governance and accountability.

MECHANISM
- [4] Bonding-only risk: nepotism, gatekeeping, exclusion of outsiders.
- [5] MKSS social audits in Rajasthan: work because bridging capital exists or is built.
- [6] Jan sunwai (public hearing): requires villagers to trust the process and each other.
- [7] Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako and Basava's Dasoha are classical bridging antecedents.
- [8] Limit: social capital strengthens governance only when it is inclusive, not insular.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDICT — Social capital earns marks only when the bonding-bridging distinction is drawn.
- ANSWER USE — Use to build any social-capital, participatory-governance or social-audit answer.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Dharma is contextually ordered duty and right conduct, not a simple...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Social capital earns marks only when the bonding-bridging distinction is drawn.

10 EIGHT-THINKER COMPARISON MATRIX

STAGE 10 · EIGHT-THINKER COMPARISON MATRIX · CENTRAL FOCUS · 11. EIGHT-THINKER COMPARISON MATRIX · (1) KAUTILYA · STRUCTURAL REALISM, EXTERNAL CONTROLS, ANTI-CORRUPTION DESIGN. · (2) BUDDHA · MIDDLE PATH PROPORTIONALITY, EIGHTFOLD PATH CONDUCT MAPPING. · (3) GANDHI

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[4] Vivekananda: Practical Vedanta, Daridra Narayana, selective learning.	VERDICT — Match the thinker's mechanism to the scenario, not just the thinker's name.
11. Eight-thinker comparison matrix	[5] Basava: Kayaka (dignified labour), Dasoha (sharing), Anubhava Mantapa.	ANSWER USE — Use as the rapid-recall grid before any thinker-matching or comparison question.
[1] Kautilya: structural realism, external controls, anti-corruption design.	[6] Guru Nanak: Kirat Karo (honest earning), Vand Chhako (equitable sharing).	EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Distinguish primary or securely attributed...
[2] Buddha: Middle Path proportionality, Eightfold Path conduct mapping.	[7] Mahavir: five Mahavratas, Anekantavada, Aparigraha.	

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Eight-thinker comparison matrix
- [1] Kautilya: structural realism, external controls, anti-corruption design.
- [2] Buddha: Middle Path proportionality, Eightfold Path conduct mapping.
- [3] Gandhi: ends-means unity, trusteeship, Seven Social Sins, Satyagraha.

MECHANISM
- [4] Vivekananda: Practical Vedanta, Daridra Narayana, selective learning.
- [5] Basava: Kayaka (dignified labour), Dasoha (sharing), Anubhava Mantapa.
- [6] Guru Nanak: Kirat Karo (honest earning), Vand Chhako (equitable sharing).
- [7] Mahavir: five Mahavratas, Anekantavada, Aparigraha.
- [8] Ambedkar: constitutional morality, equality-fraternity, institutional safeguards.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDICT — Match the thinker's mechanism to the scenario, not just the thinker's name.
- ANSWER USE — Use as the rapid-recall grid before any thinker-matching or comparison question.
- EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Distinguish primary or securely attributed...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Match the thinker's mechanism to the scenario, not just the thinker's name.

11 PYQ PATTERN AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

STAGE 11 · PYQ PATTERN AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS · CENTRAL FOCUS · 12. PYQ PATTERN AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS · (1) QUOTATION-TYPE PYQS (VIVEKANANDA, GANDHI, TIRUKKURAL) DOMINATE 2018-2025. · (2) TEACHING-TYPE PYQS (BUDDHA 2020, GURU NANAK 2023, MAHAVIR · (3) SIGNIFICANCE-TYPE PYQS (GANDHI 2018) TEST PRESENT-DAY ADMINISTRATIVE RELEVANCE. · (4) SOCIAL-CAPITAL PYQ (2023 Q6B) TESTS PUTNAM BONDING/BRIDGING WITH · (5) ANSWER SPINE

CENTRAL FOCUS → 12. PYQ pattern and answer synthesis → [1] Quotation-type PYQs (Vivekananda, Gandhi, Tirukkural) dominate 2018-2025. → [2] Teaching-type PYQs (Buddha 2020, Guru Nanak 2023, Mahavir 2025) test mechanism. → [3] Significance-type PYQs (Gandhi 2018) test present-day administrative relevance.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. PYQ pattern and answer synthesis
- [1] Quotation-type PYQs (Vivekananda, Gandhi, Tirukkural) dominate 2018–2025.
- [2] Teaching-type PYQs (Buddha 2020, Guru Nanak 2023, Mahavir 2025) test mechanism.

MECHANISM
- [3] Significance-type PYQs (Gandhi 2018) test present-day administrative relevance.
- [4] Social-capital PYQ (2023 Q6b) tests Putnam bonding/bridging with Indian examples.
- [5] Answer spine: name thinker precisely → mechanism → Indian example → limit → verdict.
- [6] Attribution cautions: Seven Social Sins wording, Anubhava Mantapa dating, three pillars.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Always translate the thinker's idea into one specific administrative practice.
- [8] Close with the realist-ideal synthesis to avoid a one-sided treatment.
- VERDICT — The highest-scoring answer moves from thinker to mechanism to example to limitation.
- ANSWER USE — Use as the revision checklist before any Indian-thinkers PYQ attempt.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — The highest-scoring answer moves from thinker to mechanism to example to limitation.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. ARCHITECTURE · 2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS · 3. DETAILED COMPARATIVE TREATMENT · 4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE · 5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES · 6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS · 7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- 1. Architecture
- 2. Concepts and distinctions
- 3. Detailed comparative treatment
- 4. Institutional and reform architecture

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 5. Indian applications and boundary cases
- 6. Limitations and trade-offs
- 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims
- 8. Advanced Prelims traps

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 9. Current application
- 10. PYQ-based analytical application
- 11. Mains-ready framework
- 12. Probable questions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels